

# Tuesday, 14 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

## Tomorrow's forecast

|                               |                                   |                                       |                                |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| LONDON<br>Overcast<br>30° 18° | BIRMINGHAM<br>Overcast<br>29° 14° | MANCHESTER<br>Mostly clear<br>27° 14° | GLASGOW<br>Overcast<br>21° 12° |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------|

01 — NEWS

## Today's top stories

- 1

**Counter-terrorism police have taken over the investigation into the death of former politician Ann Widdecombe.**

A man already in custody has now been re-arrested on suspicion of terrorism offences. Police say the investigation is ongoing.

CRIME · UK
- 2

**The UK government has announced a ban on all support for Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps.**

New powers will be used to target the group, which has been linked to death threats and intimidation on British soil. The Home Secretary said this move is crucial for national security.

POLITICS · UK
- 3

**More than 2,700 people may have died during the exceptional heatwaves that hit England and Wales in May and June.**

Experts believe most of these deaths occurred during June, when a rare red heat alert was issued. The figures highlight the severe impact of the extreme weather.

ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 4

**The UK is seeking the extradition of a man suspected of killing his wife and two daughters in Bedfordshire.**

The family members were found dead in their home, prompting a major police investigation. Authorities are working with international partners to bring the suspect back to the UK.

CRIME · UK
- 5

**Twelve people have been arrested over a threat to an Islamic event, with police saying their response saved lives.**

Home Secretary Shabana Mahmood praised the swift action of the police. The arrests underscore ongoing efforts to combat threats to public safety.

CRIME · UK

## What's coming up

### 1 **Pop superstar Ed Sheeran is helping to launch a new government-backed scheme to put music studios into local libraries.**

He'll be involved in designing the programme, which aims to inspire the next generation of musicians. Imagine discovering your talent in your local library!

**ON AIR** – What instrument would you love to learn if you had a free studio in your local library?

MUSIC · COMING UP

### 2 **Stars like Midge Ure and Jim Kerr are backing plans to create Scotland's very own Rock and Roll Hall of Fame.**

The proposed museum would be housed in Glasgow's Centre for Contemporary Arts. It aims to celebrate the rich history of Scottish music.

**ON AIR** – Which Scottish music legend absolutely HAS to be in the first induction class?

MUSIC · COMING UP

### 3 **Bollywood actor Kalki Koechlin is bringing a new play to the stage that spotlights the messier side of motherhood.**

She says society often takes mothers for granted and raising children can be a thankless job. The play promises a real, unfiltered look at parenting.

**ON AIR** – Do you think we often see a too-perfect, 'warm and fuzzy' version of motherhood in entertainment?

THEATRE · COMING UP

### 4 **Ear plugs are becoming an increasingly popular accessory at music festivals, with many now seen as a must-have.**

They're no longer just for protecting your hearing, but a fashion statement too. Festival-goers are embracing them for both style and safety.

**ON AIR** – Have you ever worn ear plugs to a concert or festival, or do you prefer to feel the full volume?

MUSIC · COMING UP

### 5 **Female singers are ruling the charts with a new wave of 'real, raw and unfiltered' authenticity.**

Artists like Olivia Rodrigo and Olivia Dean are connecting with fans through relatable styles. It seems genuine storytelling is key to pop music success right now.

**ON AIR** – Which female artist do you think is doing the best job of being truly authentic in their music right now?

MUSIC · NOW

## On the schedule

1

**Manchester United have signed Andrey Santos from Chelsea for £48 million and are close to bringing in Youri Tielemans.**

The club is making big moves in the transfer market, strengthening their squad for the upcoming season. Fans will be excited by these new additions.

**ON AIR** – Are these the signings Manchester United need to challenge for the title next season?

FOOTBALL · UK

2

**Brendon McCullum has apologised for England's recent run of seven defeats in nine games, which led to his sacking as Test coach.**

He held his hands up for the team's poor results, taking responsibility for the disappointing performances. It's been a tough period for English cricket.

**ON AIR** – Was sacking Brendon McCullum the right decision for England Test cricket, or too soon?

CRICKET · UK

3

**Argentina will wear their 'lucky' navy blue away kit when they face England in the World Cup semi-finals on Wednesday.**

England will be in their traditional all-white home strip for the crucial match. It's set to be a huge encounter between the two footballing giants.

**ON AIR** – Do you believe in 'lucky' kits or superstitions in football, or is it all down to performance on the day?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

4

**Three-time Olympic gold medallist Max Whitlock has withdrawn from this summer's Commonwealth Games in Glasgow.**

He injured his hand during training, forcing him to pull out of the highly anticipated event. It's a big blow for Team England.

**ON AIR** – How big a loss is Max Whitlock for Team England's medal hopes at the Commonwealth Games?

GYMNASTICS · UK

5

**The tee-times for the first two rounds of the 154th Open Championship at Royal Birkdale have been confirmed.**

Golf's biggest stars will descend on Southport for one of the sport's most prestigious tournaments. It promises to be a thrilling week of action.

**ON AIR** – Who are you backing to lift the Claret Jug at Royal Birkdale this year?

GOLF · THIS WEEK

## Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that a regular dose of 'happy nostalgia' can actually improve your mood and well-being.**  
Researchers found that reminiscing about positive past experiences helps reduce stress and promotes a more optimistic outlook. So, digging out those old photo albums or talking about good times is genuinely good for you!
- 2 The simple act of 'waving' at neighbours is experiencing a charming resurgence in communities.**  
It seems a friendly hand-wave or a nod of acknowledgment is becoming a popular way to foster community spirit and make walking around your local area a bit more cheerful.
- 3 A delightful trend for creating 'tiny outdoor libraries' is popping up in front gardens across the UK.**  
These charming, weather-proof boxes allow neighbours to share books, encouraging reading and a lovely sense of local exchange. It's like a free book swap right on your street!
- 4 The surprising popularity of 'board game cafes' shows that people are craving face-to-face fun.**  
These unique venues offer a vast selection of classic and modern board games, providing a relaxed space for friends and families to connect away from screens.
- 5 Many are rediscovering the joy of 'writing a proper shopping list' with pen and paper.**  
It seems the old-fashioned way helps people focus, reduces impulse buys, and offers a satisfying tick-off as items are placed in the trolley. A simple pleasure, indeed!
- 6 A lovely movement to 'collect and press autumn leaves' is encouraging families to embrace nature's artwork.**  
This creative activity turns a simple walk into a treasure hunt, resulting in beautiful natural decorations and lasting memories. A perfect way to celebrate the changing seasons.
- 7 The soothing art of 'watercolour painting' is attracting a new generation of hobbyists.**  
Its gentle learning curve and beautiful results make it a relaxing escape from daily stresses, with online tutorials making it accessible to everyone.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

### OUR SURVEY SAID

**Q** Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to decide what to wear in the morning, even if it makes us a little late?

**ANSWER:** TRYING ON AT LEAST THREE DIFFERENT OUTFITS, EVEN IF THEY ALL END UP BACK ON THE FLOOR!

**Q** Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'snack' they absolutely have to have with their afternoon cuppa. What's their go-to treat?

**ANSWER:** A DIGESTIVE BISCUIT (OR TWO, OR THREE!)

### TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you spot someone doing something really thoughtful and it just brightens your whole day?**

What's the kindest or most unexpected act of generosity you've ever witnessed from a complete stranger? Give us a call and share that heartwarming moment!

- **We all have those little 'comfort items' that just make everything feel a bit cosier, don't we?**

What's your go-to item – perhaps a favourite blanket, a specific mug, or even a well-worn pair of slippers – that brings you instant comfort at home? We'd love to hear about it!

### TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

**FACT** **Nature.** Did you know that the 'smell' of freshly cut grass is actually a distress signal released by the plants?

**FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** The sound that a camel makes is called a 'bellow', and they can hold their breath for up to 25 minutes underwater.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£7.6 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£7.6 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- The world's largest officially recognised library, the Library of Congress in Washington D.C., contains over 170 million items.
- The humble 'post-it note' was invented by accident when a scientist was trying to create a super-strong adhesive.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest, if they wanted to, by warming their wing muscles.
- The 'Oxford English Dictionary' contains over 600,000 words, making it one of the largest dictionaries in the world.
- The sound of a human yawn is contagious, and simply reading about yawning can sometimes make you yawn.
- The 'eiffel tower' can be 15 cm taller during the summer due to thermal expansion of the iron.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- The iconic 'red telephone box' in the UK was designed by architect Sir Giles Gilbert Scott.

## On this day

Day 195 of the year, 170 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Angeline of Marsciano; Christian feast day: Gaspar de Bono; Christian feast day: Camillus of Lellis (Roman Catholic Church, except in the United States); Christian feast day: Deusdedit of Canterbury. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — Bob Casale, American musician, member of Devo (died 2014)
- 1950 — Andy Newmark, American session and touring drummer (Carly Simon, George Harrison; John Lennon)
- 1940 — Susan Howatch, English author and academic
- 1932 — Rosey Grier, American football player and actor
- 1945 — Jim Gordon, American rock drummer and convicted murderer (died 2023)
- 1928 — Nancy Olson, American actress
- 1960 — Jane Lynch, American actress (Glee), comedian, author, and game show host
- 1923 — Dale Robertson, American actor (died 2013)

### THE DAY TODAY

- 1960 — Northwest Orient Airlines Flight 1-11 ditches off Polillo Island in the Philippines, killing one person and injuring 44.
- 1948 — Palmiro Togliatti, leader of the Italian Communist Party, is shot and wounded near the Italian Parliament.
- 2016 — A man ploughs a truck into a Bastille Day celebration in Nice, France, killing 86 people and injuring another 434 before being shot by police.

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1942 — In the Wardha session of Congress, the "Quit India" resolution is approved, authorising Mahatma Gandhi to campaign for India's independence from Britain.
- 1983 — Mario Bros. is released in Japan, beginning the popular Super Mario Bros franchise.

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2016 — A man ploughs a truck into a Bastille Day celebration in Nice, France, killing 86 people and injuring another 434 before being shot by police.

- 1881 — American outlaw Billy the Kid is shot and killed by Sheriff Pat Garrett in the Maxwell House at Fort Sumner, New Mexico.
- 1900 — Armies of the Eight-Nation Alliance capture Tientsin during the Boxer Rebellion.



## A peek at tomorrow

Day 196 of the year, 169 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abhai (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Anne-Marie Javouhey; Christian feast day: Bernhard II, Margrave of Baden-Baden; Christian feast day: Bonaventure. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1952 — Terry O'Quinn, American actor
- 1973 — Brian Austin Green, American actor
- 1935 — Alex Karras, American football player, wrestler, and actor (died 2012)
- 1944 — Millie Jackson, American singer-songwriter
- 1977 — Ray Toro, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1981 — Taylor Kinney, American actor
- 1968 — Eddie Griffin, American comedian, actor, and producer
- 1958 — Gary Heale, English footballer and coach

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1971 — The United Red Army is founded in Japan.
- 1983 — An attack at Orly Airport in Paris is launched by Armenian militant organisation ASALA, leaving eight people dead and 55 injured.
- 2016 — Factions of the Turkish Armed Forces attempt a coup.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1888 — The stratovolcano Mount Bandai erupts, killing approximately 500 people in Fukushima Prefecture, Japan.
- 2006 — Twitter, later one of the largest social media platforms in the world, is launched.

# Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

|        |                                                      |
|--------|------------------------------------------------------|
| FRI 17 | Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX);<br>Cut Off |
| FRI 24 | Heads of State; Untitled DCU                         |
| FRI 31 | Spider-Man: Brand New Day                            |

AUGUST 2026

|        |                                                    |
|--------|----------------------------------------------------|
| FRI 7  | Once Upon a Time in a Cinema                       |
| FRI 14 | Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino<br>Movie |
| FRI 21 | Mutiny; The Bride!                                 |
| FRI 28 | Crime 101; Outcome                                 |

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

|        |                       |
|--------|-----------------------|
| FRI 4  | Conjuring: Last Rites |
| FRI 11 | Resident Evil reboot  |
| FRI 18 | The Black Phone 2     |
| FRI 25 | Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)   |

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

|        |                                         |
|--------|-----------------------------------------|
| FRI 16 | Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller |
| FRI 23 | Frankenstein (del Toro)                 |

## On the sporting calendar

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### JULY 2026

|                |                                  |
|----------------|----------------------------------|
| 4–26 JUL       | Tour de France (Cycling)         |
| 16–19 JUL      | The Open Championship (Golf)     |
| 18–26 JUL      | World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool |
| 23 JUL – 2 AUG | Commonwealth Games, Glasgow      |

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### AUGUST 2026

|        |                                        |
|--------|----------------------------------------|
| W/C 10 | Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)   |
| SAT 15 | Premier League season begins (2026/27) |
| 22–23  | Belgian Grand Prix (F1)                |